

Chapter 172

Transport Controls, Timeline Navigation, and Markers

The Fairlight page has unique transport control, zooming, and scrolling options not found in the other pages of DaVinci Resolve that help you to work with audio more efficiently.

This chapter covers how to navigate around the Fairlight version of the Timeline.

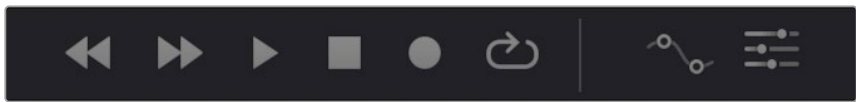
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Transport Controls and JKL Navigation

Because of the Fairlight page’s audio-focused workflow, the transport and playback controls differ from those found in the Media, Edit, Color, and Deliver pages.

Transport Controls



Fairlight page transport controls

The Fairlight transport controls are also designed to mirror their counterparts on the Fairlight control panels. They include the following functions:

- Rewind and Fast Forward:** Initiates accelerated playback through the Timeline in either direction. Pressing either of these buttons multiple times speeds up this motion, cycling through 8x, 24x, 60x, 150x, and 360x play speeds.
- Play:** Plays forward. Identical to pressing the Spacebar or L keys while playback is stopped.
- Stop:** Stops playback. Identical to pressing the Spacebar or K keys while playback is engaged.
- Record:** Initiates recording if you have an audio source patched to a track, and if that track is enabled for recording. For more information about recording, see *Chapter 173, “Recording.”*
- Loop:** Toggles looped playback off and on. While looped playback is on, playback will loop at the end of the Timeline, and will also loop when you use the Play In to Out command, and will continue to loop automatically until you stop playback.
- Automation controls:** This button exposes the automation toolbar.

For more information about recording automation, see *Chapter 178, “Mix Automation.”*

Using JKL to Control Playback

The JKL keyboard shortcuts are common to many editing applications, and experienced editors know these to be some of the most useful controls for playback and editing there are. Here’s a list of the many different ways you can use these three keyboard shortcuts to play through clips and timelines as you work.

J	Plays 100% backward.
K	Stops playback.
L	Plays 100% forward.
Press J repeatedly	Increases backward play speed each time you press J, for a range of fast-reverse speeds.
Press L repeatedly	Increases forward play speed each time you press L, for a range of fast-forward speeds.

Shift-J	Plays in fast reverse.
Shift-L	Plays in fast forward.
K+J	Plays backward at slow motion (with slow motion audio playback).
K+L	Plays forward at slow motion (with pitch-corrected audio playback on OS X).
Pressing K while tapping J	Moves the playhead back one frame.
Pressing K while tapping L	Moves the playhead forward one frame.

If you're using Fairlight with the keyboard, then this will probably become one of the main ways you move the playhead around in DaVinci Resolve.

NOTE: All of the keyboard commands listed in this document are based on the DaVinci Resolve keyboard customization preset. There is great power in the remapping of keyboard commands to systems that may be more familiar to you like Premiere Pro or Pro Tools. However, if their keyboard command set does not offer the same commands as the DaVinci Resolve keyboard commands, they won't work the same. For instance, the Pro Tools keyboard preset does not support J-K-L timeline navigation.

Dragging the Playhead to Scrub

You can also drag the playhead left and right to scrub through the visible area of the Timeline by clicking and dragging anywhere within the Timeline ruler at the top of the Timeline, directly below the toolbar. If you're zoomed in at a reasonable level for editing, scrubbing the playhead using your pointer will result in smooth, tape-like slow and fast audio playback, giving you a great deal of precision while trimming audio.

Looping Playback

Two controls govern looping on the Fairlight page, similarly to how looping works on the Edit page.

Loop: Command-Forward Slash (/). Toggles looped playback off and on. While looped playback is on, playback initiated with any of the following commands will loop automatically until you stop playback.

Play In to Out: Option-Forward Slash (/). If you've marked a section of a clip or timeline with In and Out points, this command lets you preview how it will play.

Loop Jog Scrubbing

Currently available only on the Fairlight page, choosing Timeline > Loop Jog enables a brief sample preview to be heard while scrubbing the playhead through the Timeline. This can make it easier to recognize bits of dialog or music as you're quickly scrubbing through tracks, in situations where you're trying to locate specific lines or music cues. It also enables this brief sample preview to loop endlessly when you hold the playhead on a frame, so you can pause while scrubbing and hear (by default) the current 80 ms prior to the playhead as it loops.

A pair of settings in the User Preferences let you customize this behavior.

Loop Jog Alignment: Three options let you choose whether you loop audio Pre the position of the playhead, Centered on the playhead, or Post the position of the playhead.

Loop Jog Width: A field lets you choose how many milliseconds of audio to loop when Loop Jog is enabled. How many milliseconds of audio corresponds to one frame depends on the frame rate of the video. For example, at a frame rate of 25 fps, there are $1000/25 = 40$ ms per frame, so the default value of 80 ms equals two frames of looping.

Moving the Playhead Using Timecode

You can use absolute or relative timecode entry to move the playhead in the Timeline. Timecode entry lets you move the playhead very precisely or jump to specific timecode values really quickly.

How to Enter Timecode Values

When entering timecode, type each pair of hour, minute, second, and frame values from left to right, with a period representing a pair of zeros for fast entry. The numbers you enter appear in the Timecode field at the upper right-hand corner of the Viewer with focus. When you're finished typing, press the Enter key to execute the timecode command. The rules for timecode entry are as follows:

- The right-most pair of timecode values (or period) you enter is always the frame number.
- A period to the left or to the right of any number you type is considered to be a pair of zeroes.
- A single period between two numbers is considered to either be a single zero or ignored if it's between two pairs of numbers.
- Any untyped pairs of values to the left of what you enter are assumed to be whatever those values were prior to the timecode you entered; this makes it easy to type partial timecode values even when the Timeline starts at hour one.
- It's not necessary to enter colons or semicolons.

IMPORTANT: With full length keyboards, you can use the number pad for implicit timecode entry without invoking the Go To Timecode action (=). When using a multicam or printer light operation, any already mapped number pad key will continue to invoke actions like switching angles or incrementing color values.

When using the number keys above the letters on a keyboard, you must first select Go To Timecode (=), or click in the field you wish to change before entering a new value.

Absolute Timecode Entry

Absolute timecode is entered simply by typing the timecode value you want to move the playhead to, and when you press the Return key, the playhead will move to that timecode value.

Here are some examples of absolute timecode entry using this method:

Original TC Value	User-Typed Value	New TC Value
01:10:10:10	15245218	15:24:52:18
01:10:10:10	2..	01:02:00:00
01:10:10:10	15	01:10:10:15
01:10:10:10	12	01:10:10:12
01:10:10:10	1.2	01:10:01:02
01:10:10:10	1115..	11:15:00:00
01:10:10:10	23...	23:00:00:00

Relative Timecode Entry

Relative timecode is entered by starting the timecode value with a plus (+) or minus (–). Adding a plus results in the value you type being added to the current timecode value for purposes of offsetting the playhead from its current position. Adding a minus will subtract the value you type from the current timecode value. Here are three examples of relative timecode entry:

User-Typed Value	Result
+20.	00:00:20:00 is added to the current timecode value.
+3..	00:03:00:00 is added to the current timecode value.
–5	00:00:00:05 is subtracted from the current timecode value.

Clip, Marker, and Track Navigation

The Up and Down Arrow keys are used to move the playhead from one edit point to the next in the Fairlight page Timeline, just as in the Edit page Timeline.

However, holding Command-Option down while using the Arrow keys gives you Fairlight page-specific behaviors that are used to navigate among clips, markers, and tracks in the Fairlight page in a way that’s different than other pages of DaVinci Resolve but very useful to the way the Fairlight page operates. This section covers the basics.

Selecting Tracks

Which tracks are selected determine the behavior of the Arrow keys.

- **In Pointer mode:** You can select tracks by clicking or Command-clicking (to select multiple tracks) anywhere in the background area or on the track number of the track headers. If you click and drag in the track header, you can use a bounding box to select multiple tracks. Pointer mode will not select in unused areas of the Timeline.
- **In Range or Focus mode:** You can select tracks by clicking or Command-clicking anywhere either in the background area or on the track number of the track header, or in any unused area of the track itself in the Timeline. If you click and drag, you can use a bounding box to select multiple tracks.

Moving the Clip Selection

The Command-Option-Left and Command-Option-Right Arrow key shortcuts are used to move the playhead left and right in the Timeline, navigating from clip to clip or from marker to marker. How these keys function depends on whether or not one or more tracks is selected in the Timeline.

- **If no tracks are selected:** The Left and Right Arrow keys will jump the playhead from Timeline marker to Timeline marker. Clip markers will be ignored.
- **If one or more tracks are selected:** The Left/Right Arrow keys will jump the playhead among clip In points, clip Out points, and Timeline markers.

Moving the Track Selection

The Command-Option-Up and Command-Option-Down Arrow key shortcuts are used to move the track selection up and down in the Timeline, changing which tracks are selected. By changing which tracks are selected, you can alter which clip's In and Out points are used to jump the playhead around the Timeline.

If no tracks are selected, then nothing happens.

Zooming and Scrolling

The Fairlight page has several methods of zooming into and out of the Timeline, and scrolling when you're zoomed to the point where your edited sequence of clips extends past the left and right edge of the visible timeline.

The Playhead

Zooming is always centered on the position of the Playhead. By default the Playhead moves along the Timeline as it plays. However, Fairlight offers the option of a Fixed Playhead where the Timeline moves while the Playhead remains centered.



The Playhead options are found in the Timeline Scrolling panel.

Setting the Zoom Level of the Timeline

Depending on how you like to work, there are several methods of zooming into and out of the Timeline.

Using the Vertical Zoom slider: A pair of sliders at the right of the toolbar let you zoom vertically and horizontally. The first one lets you scroll vertically in order to see more detail in the height of your waveforms. If no tracks are selected, then zooming is centered on the top audio track in the Timeline. If one or more tracks are selected, then zooming is centered on the topmost selected audio track.

Using the Horizontal Zoom slider: A pair of sliders at the right of the toolbar let you zoom vertically and horizontally. The second one lets you zoom horizontally in order to see more detail in the width of your waveforms.

Pressing Command-Equal (=) and Command-Minus (-): Command-Equal (also referred to as Command-Plus) and Command-Minus let you zoom horizontally into the Timeline.

Use Shift-Z to Zoom to Fit: Command-Z lets you zoom horizontally to fit all clips in your program to the available width of the Timeline.

Using scroll controls of your pointing device to scroll horizontally: Holding the Option key down and using the scroll wheel (or scroll control) of your pointing device will zoom horizontally into the Timeline. Holding the Command key down and using the scroll wheel will move the Timeline earlier or later than its current time, without moving Playhead.

Using scroll controls of your pointing device to scroll vertically: Holding the Shift key down and using the scroll wheel (or scroll control) lets you zoom vertically in the Timeline. In this case, if no tracks are selected, then zooming is centered on the top audio track in the Timeline. If one or more tracks are selected, then zooming is centered on the topmost selected audio track.

Using the Fairlight panel's Jog/Edit wheel: If you have a Fairlight panel, you can hold the ZOOM button down while turning the Jog/Edit wheel to zoom into the Timeline at the position of the playhead.

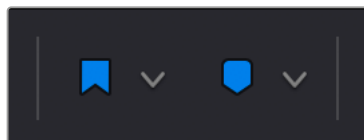
Scrolling Through the Timeline

However closely you're zoomed into the Timeline, if you're zoomed enough so that clips extend past the visible area of the Timeline, scroll bars appear below. If the playhead is offscreen, a small orange tic mark indicates its position relative to the entire timeline, which is represented by the total width of the scroll bar's background.

If you drag the playhead, or otherwise use any of the transport controls or playback key shortcuts to move through the Timeline, the contents of the Timeline refresh every time the playhead hits the left or right edge of what's visible.

Using Flags

Flags are meant to mark an entire clip, and they also flag every other clip in the Timeline that shares the same Media Pool source clip, making this a handy way of quickly identifying which clips in a given timeline come from the same Media Pool source. Flags are visible in every page of DaVinci Resolve, making them an excellent method of tracking media from page to page.



The Flag and Marker buttons and pop-ups.

You can apply multiple flags to clips, with a variety of colors to choose from. In addition to flagging specific media files, flags can be useful for sorting by column in the Media Pool, as well as a variety of other operations. Whenever you enter text into a flag, it displays a small dot that indicates there's more information inside of it.

Methods for flagging clips in the Fairlight page:

To flag a clip: Select one or more clips, and either click the Flag button to flag that clip with the current color, or click the Flag pop-up in the toolbar to choose a different color and then click the Flag button. In the Edit page, flags appear in the Timeline superimposed in the name bar of each clip.

To remove all flags from a clip: Select one or more clips with flags you want to remove, then click the Flag pop-up in the toolbar, and choose the top "Clear All" option.

To change the Flag color or remove individually: Double-click the Flag icon on the clip and a Marker dialog box appears to change the Flag color, remove the flag, or make a note regarding the flag.

Using Markers

Markers are used to call attention to a particular frame within a specific clip. Markers can be individually colored, and can have customized name and note text. Whenever you enter text into a marker, that marker displays a small dot that indicates there's more information inside of it. Once placed, markers snap to In and Out points, edit points, the playhead, and other markers whenever snapping is enabled, making it easy to use markers to "measure" edits and trims that you make in the Timeline. Markers are visible in every page of DaVinci Resolve, making them an excellent method of tracking frames in clips and specific moments in the Timeline from page to page.

You can add markers to the Timeline (in the Timeline ruler) or to clips. The full procedures for placing and editing markers in the Fairlight page's onscreen interface are identical to those for the Edit page, so for more information, see *Chapter 41, "Marking and Finding Clips in the Timeline."* For now, here's a summary.

Adding Markers to Clips

The following procedures describe how to add markers to clips in the Timeline of the Media page.

To mark a clip in the Timeline, do one of the following:

- Select one or more clips you want to mark, then move the playhead to the frame of a selected clip in the Timeline, and click the Marker button in the toolbar (or press M) to place a marker at that frame, using the current color (if multiple overlapping clips are selected, you'll add a marker to all clips).
- To place a marker during playback and immediately open the marker dialog to enter a name or note within it, select one or more clips you want to mark, play through the selection until you want to place a mark, then press Command-M. Playback pauses until you enter some text and close the marker dialog again, at which point playback continues.
- Select one or more clips you want to mark, and then click the Marker pop-up to choose a different color, and click the Marker button.

Adding Markers to Timelines

You can also place markers of any color into the Timeline ruler to denote specific times for future reference, or add notes about issues you want to keep track of. You should note that all markers placed on clips or in the Timeline also appear within the Mini-Timeline of the Color page, making it easy to place notes to reference particular audio cues that might be valuable when editing or grading.

To mark the Timeline itself, make sure all clips are deselected, and do one of the following:

- Click the Marker button (or press M) to place a marker of the currently selected color in the Timeline ruler.
- To place a marker during playback and immediately open the marker dialog to enter a name or note within it, select one or more clips you want to mark, then press Command-M. Playback pauses until you enter some text and close the marker dialog again, at which point playback continues.
- Click the Marker pop-up to choose a different color, and click the Marker button.
- Right-click in the Timeline ruler and choose a marker color from the Add Marker submenu of the contextual menu.